

Incorporating Goalies Into Everyday Team Practices

Katie Jablynski

About Me

- 15 years of playing experience
- 7 years of coaching experience
- Assistant and goalie coach, Belle Tire 14U AAA
- Goalie coach for Little Caesars Tier II programs
- Michigan Goaltending Development Coordinator
- Experience coaching goalies from 8U through ACHA Division I





My why?



Why should you incorporate goalies?

- Goalies are a part of the team not just the final step of a drill.
 - Team practices provide game like reads that isolated goalie drills cannot.
 - Team practices allow goalies to develop decision making, puck tracking, communication, and IQ.
 - Small adjustments can create better learning opportunities for skaters and goalies.
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What is Technique?

For goalies

- Stance
- Skating
- Positioning
- Save selection
- Rebound control
- Recovery

For players

- Skating
- Stick handling
- Shooting
- Passing

What is skill?

What is skill?

Execution in a game.

What is skill?

Execution in a game.

- Technique
 - Decision making
 - Ability to perform in live game
 - Hockey IQ
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Linking Activities to the Game Environmental Design Continuum



Adapted from: Newcombe, D (2017) Environmental Design Framework, *Scientific Conference on Motor Skill Acquisition*, Kisakallio, Finland

So how do we move drills toward the “game” side of the continuum?

Constraints: Small Changes That Shape the Drill

Space

- Boundaries
- Net location
- Starting positions

People

- Number of players
- Pressure or opposition
- Screens and traffic

Rules

- Puck starting location
- Time limits
- Point system
- Required passes or shot locations

The goal is not to redesign the entire practice. It is to adjust one or two constraints to improve the reads available to the goalie.

Goalie Friendly Practice Checklist



Video



Welcome



This website was developed as part of the [USA Hockey Goaltending Gold Certification Program](#). All capstone projects for the program must improve the future of the position and produce a resource that will be shared and can be repeated by all coaches across the country. The goal of this website is to inform and equip clubs and coaches to best develop their goalies, and to help all goalies reach their full potential. This website lowers the barriers to all coaches becoming goalie coaches! Sign up for a Goaltending certification course on the [USA Hockey Learning Center](#).

[I Need a Drill!](#)

[Share Goalie Gen](#)

For Organizations

Tools and resources for managing club-wide goaltending development programs.

[Generate Club Development Plan](#)

[About Club Plans](#)

[More Club Resources](#)

For Coaches

Access drills, evaluation forms, and coaching resources for goalie development.

[Generate Team Development Plan](#)

[About Team Plans](#)

[Team Drills with Goalie Focus](#)

[Goalie Drills](#)

[Goalie Evaluations](#)

[More Coach Resources](#)

For Goalies

Resources and tools to support your goalie development journey.

[Generate Goalie Journal](#)

[About Goalie Journals](#)

[Goalie Resources](#)

3 Key Takeaways

1. Goalies are players, not drill finishers.

- Every drill should provide meaningful learning opportunities for the goalie—not just repetitions.

2. Skill develops through realistic decisions.

- Technique is important, but game-like reads, pressure, and decision-making create transferable skill.

3. Small changes make a big impact.

- You don't need to redesign your practice. Adjusting one or two constraints can improve development for both goalies and skaters.

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Thanks to

Joe Bonnett

Zach Nowak

James Kujawski

Patrick Boyle